COLORADO
Information Security
Governor's Office of Information Technology

TS-CISO-003: Remote Access Standard

Document ID	TS-CISO-003
Title	Remote Access Standard v2026
Executive Sponsor	Jill Fraser, Chief Information Security Officer
Issuing Authority	Governor's Office of Information Technology (OIT)
Applies to	All state government agencies, employees, contractors, vendors, and external users who access state government information systems and applications, regardless of location or device, including all applications, hosting environments, and physical and connected technologies.
Instrument Type	Standard
Version	4.0
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Purpose

This standard defines security requirements for remote access to State information systems and applications, including on-premises and cloud environments. It supports compliance with the Colorado Information Security Policies (CISPs).

Scope

This standard applies to all state government agencies, employees, contractors, vendors, and external users who access state government information systems and applications, regardless of location or device. This includes all applications and hosting environments, and access to physical and connected technologies.

Requirements

The appropriate Remote Access standard requirements are listed below. Additional requirements must be implemented based on the regulated data type(s).

Remote Access Methods

The following methods, with the stated restrictions, are allowed:

Device Type	Access Method/Protocol	Requirement
State-Managed Devices	State-managed VPN (client-to-site)	Must adhere to all applicable state security standards and configurations. Any endpoints that connect to internal resources must use

Device Type	Access Method/Protocol	Requirement
		the approved state client-to-site (individual) VPN.
External/Edge Networks	State-approved site-to-site VPN	Must use the state-approved site-to-site VPN to connect to any internal state resources.
Non-State-Managed Devices	State-managed Virtual Desktop Solution	Must connect to a virtual desktop solution managed by the state.

Security Requirements

Requirement	Detail
Strong Authentication	All external remote access connections shall require multi-factor authentication (MFA) (e.g., username/password + hardware token, biometric authentication).
Session Management	Enforcing strong session IDs, timeouts, and locks.
Least Privilege	Remote access users shall only be granted the minimum necessary privileges to perform their job duties.
Data Encryption	All data transmitted over the remote access connection shall be encrypted using strong encryption protocols.

Data Handling

Remote access users shall adhere to all applicable data security policies and standards, including data classification, handling, and storage requirements.

Exceptions

All exceptions must be documented, justified, and approved by the State of Colorado's Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) or other designated authority. Compensating controls must be documented, implemented, and maintained.

Compliance

The Information Security Office will monitor and advise on compliance with this standard.